

FLIGHTLESS GIANT

DROMORNIS

Although the massive prehistoric bird *Dromornis* evolved from ancestors that could fly, it was flightless—its large, bulky frame was built for power rather than speed. *Dromornis* had a powerful beak—which it probably used to forage for fruit, nuts, and foliage—and a large gut that helped it digest plant matter. This bird was once thought to be a relative of modern emus and ostriches, but recent research has shown it to be more closely related to waterfowl, such as ducks and geese.

Strong beak

Youngsters were probably covered in soft, downy feathers.

AT A GLANCE

- **HEIGHT** 10 ft (3 m)
- **DIET** Herbivore
- **LIVED** 8 MYA
- **HABITAT** Subtropical open woodlands

